



Security Training for Seafarers (STSDSD)

30 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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Practice Set 1

Q1. One can ensure structural security by:

- A) Sealing off the ship
- B) Limiting Access Points
- C) Locking all doors
- D) Limiting entry into the ship

Correct Answer: B (Limiting Access Points)

Explanation: Structural security is enhanced by physical measures that restrict unauthorized movement. Limiting access points allows the crew to better monitor and control entries, significantly reducing the risk of unauthorized boarding or intrusion.

Q2. The port facility is required to appoint:

- A) Company Security Officer
- B) Port Facility Security Officer
- C) Ship Security Officer
- D) Port Facility Security Assessment (PFSA)

Correct Answer: B (Port Facility Security Officer)

Explanation: The ISPS Code mandates that every port facility must appoint a Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO). This individual is responsible for the development, implementation, and maintenance of the Port Facility Security Plan.

Q3. The term "security level" refers to:

- A) The degree of risk that a security incident will occur
- B) The level of casualties
- C) The level of danger
- D) The probability of an attack

Correct Answer: A (The degree of risk that a security incident will occur)

Explanation: Security levels, ranging from 1 to 3, quantify the risk of a security incident. Level 1 is normal, Level 2 indicates an elevated risk, and Level 3 represents the highest risk when an incident is probable or imminent.

Q4. Controlling embarkation of persons and their effects is done by:

- A) Visitor control, personal effects, and body searches
- B) Baggage control, personal effects, and body searches
- C) Access control, personal effects, and body searches
- D) CCTV control, personal effects, and baggage control

Correct Answer: C (Access control, personal effects, and body searches)

Explanation: Access control is the primary method for maintaining ship security. It involves verifying the identity of personnel and



Q5. To prevent a pirate attack, the first line of defense is:

- A) Proper lookout
- B) Maximize the speed of your vessel
- C) Seal all entrances to accommodation
- D) Early detection

Correct Answer: D (Early detection)

Explanation: Early detection is the most vital defensive layer in maritime security against piracy. By identifying potential threats from a distance, the crew gains sufficient time to maneuver, increase speed, and initiate other protective measures.

Q6. IMO introduced the ISPS Code and made it mandatory to enhance security in:

- A) July 2004
- B) December 2002
- C) July 1998
- D) After the 9/11 incident

Correct Answer: A (July 2004)

Explanation: The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code was adopted by the IMO as a direct response to the heightened global security concerns following the 9/11 incident, becoming mandatory in July 2004.

Q7. To meet the requirements of the ISPS Code, the most effective and practical methods used by port authorities for surveillance is:

- A) Dedicated task force to bolster security
- B) Use of security cameras
- C) Use of thermal cameras
- D) Trained security staff

Correct Answer: B (Use of security cameras)

Explanation: Security cameras (CCTV) are a cost-effective and continuous surveillance method required by the ISPS Code. They allow for monitoring of restricted areas and access points, providing a visual deterrent and an audit trail of activity.

Q8. Security equipment and systems need not be:

- A) Calibrated and tested before every use
- B) Kept under lock and key
- C) Tried out during each security drill
- D) Included in your pre-maintenance schedule (VMS)

Correct Answer: B (Kept under lock and key)

Explanation: Security equipment must be readily available when needed; therefore, it should be stored securely but accessible to authorized personnel. Keeping them under lock and key prevents tampering and ensures the gear is ready for use during a security threat.

Q9. Ship Security Assessments are the responsibility of:

- A) PFSO
- B) SSO
- C) Designated person
- D) CSO (Company Security Officer)

Correct Answer: D (CSO (Company Security Officer))



Q10. The use of water spray and foam monitors to deliver jets of water on an attacking skiff is intended to:

- A) Deter the attackers
- B) Disable their weapons
- C) Create a distraction
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Water monitors are non-lethal, effective deterrents against pirate skiffs. They are used to create a physical barrier of water, hamper the visibility and maneuverability of the attackers, and protect the vessel's hull from boarding.

Q11. A security alert should be issued:

- A) Immediately upon detection of a security threat
- B) Only after confirming the threat
- C) When the ship is in territorial waters
- D) At the discretion of the Master

Correct Answer: A (Immediately upon detection of a security threat)

Explanation: Prompt action is critical to maritime security. An alert must be issued immediately upon the detection of a threat to activate the ship's security protocols and ensure all crew members are warned and move to safety.

Q12. The person ultimately responsible for the security of the ship is:

- A) The Master
- B) The Chief Officer
- C) The Security Officer
- D) The Company Security Officer

Correct Answer: A (The Master)

Explanation: While security officers handle the technical implementation of security plans, the Master retains the ultimate authority and responsibility for the ship, its cargo, and the safety of all personnel on board.

Q13. Security drills should be conducted:

- A) Monthly
- B) Quarterly
- C) Annually
- D) As per the Ship Security Plan (SSP)

Correct Answer: D (As per the Ship Security Plan (SSP))

Explanation: Security drills and exercises must be conducted at regular intervals as specified in the ship's security plan to ensure the crew is proficient in executing security procedures and responding to different alert levels.

Q14. A security breach investigation should include:

- A) Interviews with witnesses
- B) Examination of evidence
- C) Review of security procedures
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: A thorough security investigation is essential to prevent recurrence. It requires a holistic review of what occurred,



Q15. The Designated Security Duties (DSD) officer is responsible for:

- A) Implementing the Ship Security Plan (SSP)
- B) Conducting security drills
- C) Investigating security breaches
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Seafarers assigned Designated Security Duties (DSD) are integral to maintaining ship security. Their responsibilities, as outlined in the ISPS Code and STCW, encompass active implementation of the SSP, conducting security drills, and assisting the SSO in investigating security incidents. Therefore, all listed activities fall within their remit.

Q16. Corrective actions should be taken when:

- A) A security incident occurs
- B) A security drill is not conducted as planned
- C) A vulnerability in the security system is identified
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Corrective actions are crucial for an effective Ship Security Plan (SSP) and overall maritime security. They are required proactively when vulnerabilities are identified, reactively after a security incident, and when scheduled security drills or exercises are not performed as planned, ensuring continuous improvement and compliance with ISPS Code.

Q17. Actions which are not necessarily part of an assessment of a security drill include:

- A) Debriefing by Master and SSO
- B) Disciplinary action against any crew member
- C) Analysis and discussions on takeaways from drills
- D) Written report of the drill

Correct Answer: B (Disciplinary action against any crew member)

Explanation: The assessment of a security drill, as per the ISPS Code, focuses on evaluating performance, identifying deficiencies, and improving the Ship Security Plan (SSP). It involves debriefing, analysis, and a written report. Disciplinary action is generally not an immediate or necessary part of the drill assessment process itself, which is for learning and improvement.

Q18. Overt methods to overcome security measures include:

- A) Forcefully breaking and entering
- B) Disabling alarms
- C) While the guards are sleeping
- D) Befriending the crew members

Correct Answer: A (Forcefully breaking and entering)

Explanation: Overt methods to overcome security measures are those that are open, observable, and often involve direct confrontation or visible force. Forcefully breaking and entering is a clear example of an overt act, as it directly and visibly challenges physical security barriers. Other options generally describe covert or subtle approaches.



- A) CSO
- B) SSO
- C) Master
- D) Chief Officer

Correct Answer: C (Master)

Explanation: The Declaration of Security (DoS) is a critical document under the ISPS Code, establishing shared security responsibilities between a ship and a port facility. It is signed by the Master of the ship and the Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO), as the Master holds ultimate authority and responsibility for the ship's operations and security.

Q20. The Global Integrated Shipping Information System (GIS) is accessible to:

- A) IMO members
- B) International Maritime Bureau
- C) Contracting governments
- D) Ship owners

Correct Answer: A (IMO members)

Explanation: The Global Integrated Shipping Information System (GIS) is an IMO platform designed to provide restricted access to various maritime data. Its primary users and those with comprehensive access include IMO member states and related organizations for regulatory and enforcement purposes, supporting the implementation of international conventions.

Q21. Security measures are not necessarily extended by the contracting governments for:

- A) Offshore supply vessels (OSVs)
- B) Fishing vessels
- C) Passenger and cargo ships in coastal trade
- D) Naval vessels

Correct Answer: B (Fishing vessels)

Explanation: The ISPS Code primarily applies to passenger ships, cargo ships over 500 gross tonnage, and mobile offshore drilling units engaged on international voyages. Fishing vessels are generally excluded from the mandatory provisions of the ISPS Code, although some national regulations might impose security measures.

Q22. To ensure ship's personnel are doing their security duties properly, one must carry out:

- A) Continuous survey
- B) On-scene security survey
- C) Intermediate survey
- D) Surprise survey

Correct Answer: D (Surprise survey)

Explanation: To effectively verify that ship's personnel are performing their security duties correctly and consistently, surprise surveys or inspections are often employed. This method provides an unannounced assessment of adherence to the Ship Security Plan (SSP) and ISPS Code procedures, revealing actual operational practices rather than prepared demonstrations.

Q23. If a suspicious object or package is found on board, the first action should be to:

- A) Activate radio communication
- B) Seize and open the package
- C) Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item
- D) Inform the person of your suspicion

Correct Answer: C (Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item)



Q24. The protection of people is called:

- A) Ship security
- B) Human security
- C) Crew security
- D) Physical security

Correct Answer: D (Physical security)

Explanation: In the context of security measures like those under the ISPS Code, "physical security" specifically refers to the protection of personnel, assets, and facilities from unauthorized access, damage, or harm. This includes controlling access, surveillance, and protective barriers for people on board, as opposed to broader concepts like human security.

Q25. Security equipment and systems disallowed for use on board include:

- A) Locking equipment for all external doors
- B) Firearms
- C) Razor wire and bar fence wires
- D) Searchlights

Correct Answer: B (Firearms)

Explanation: Under international maritime law and the ISPS Code, commercial vessels are generally prohibited from carrying firearms, except in very specific circumstances with explicit authorization from the Flag State and coastal states. Other items like locks, razor wire (with proper precautions), and searchlights are commonly used security enhancements.

Q26. The mandatory requirements of the ISPS Code are contained in:

- A) Conference resolutions
- B) Part A
- C) Part B
- D) Introduction

Correct Answer: B (Part A)

Explanation: The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code is divided into two parts. Part A contains the mandatory requirements, including those for Ship Security Plans (SSP) and Port Facility Security Plans (PFSP). Part B provides non-mandatory guidance for the implementation of these requirements.

Q27. Complaints of security incidents on board do not require:

- A) Periodic testing of communication equipment
- B) Ship Security Plan to be displayed
- C) Immediate investigation
- D) Reporting to the port facility

Correct Answer: C (Immediate investigation)

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan (SSP) contains sensitive information regarding the ship's security arrangements and vulnerabilities, as per the ISPS Code. It is a confidential document that should only be accessible to authorized personnel and is explicitly not to be displayed openly on board, ensuring its integrity and effectiveness.



Q28. If a suspicious object or package is found on board, the first action should be to:

- A) Activate radio communication
- B) Seize and open the package
- C) Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item
- D) Inform the person of your suspicion

Correct Answer: C (Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item)

Explanation: When a suspicious object is found, the immediate priority, as per ship security procedures, is to ensure safety and prevent potential harm. Cordoning off and controlling the area isolates the threat and allows for further assessment by qualified personnel, following the Ship Security Plan (SSP) protocols.

Q29. The protection of people is called:

- A) Ship security
- B) Human security
- C) Crew security
- D) Physical security

Correct Answer: D (Physical security)

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Q30. Security equipment and systems disallowed for use on board include:

- A) Locking equipment for all external doors
- B) Firearms
- C) Razor wire and bar fence wires
- D) Searchlights

Correct Answer: B (Firearms)

Explanation: Under international maritime law and the ISPS Code, commercial vessels are generally prohibited from carrying firearms, except in very specific circumstances with explicit authorization from the Flag State and coastal states. Other items like locks, razor wire (with proper precautions), and searchlights are commonly used security enhancements.